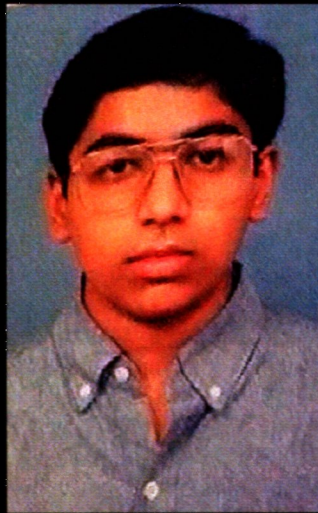


KAHEEL AHMED: The Executionist

How a brilliant aeronautical engineer from Bangalore became India's first global jihadi

EARLY LIFE

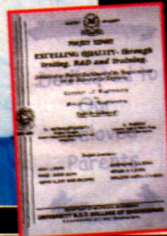
- Born in Bangalore in 1979 to Dr Maqbool and Dr Zakia Ahmed, physicians who worked in Iran and later Saudi Arabia. Schooled at the Indian Embassy School in Damam.
- Comes to Bangalore to study at the Aurobindo High School in Jayanagar between 1992 and 1994.
- Parents return for good to India in 1994 and settle at Banashankari in Bangalore.
- Studies at Bangalore National College until 1996. Ranks 5,711 in CET, secures admission to UBDT College of Engineering, Devangere.



THE PRODIGAL SON Kafeel as a student; distraught parents Dr Maqbool and Dr Zakia Ahmed recently in Bangalore



A RECLUSIVE KAFEEL Posed for a group photo with classmates just once (left) before graduating in 2001; (inset) his project report on quality control



GROWING UP

- Joins Devangere's UBDT College (left) in 1996. Shy, sensitive but extremely bright and helpful.
- Doesn't hang out with friends or live in the college hostel. Doesn't seek scholarship despite scoring 80-90 per cent.
- Heads team of five students which submits a well-researched project report in 1999. Ranks fifth in the university with 87.5 per cent.

TRANSFORMATION

- Pursues M.Tech at Queen's University, Belfast, in 2002. Active in student Islamic affairs.
- Returns to work briefly in Infotech, Bangalore in 2005-06. Is completely radicalised.
- Goes to Anglia Polytechnic University in Cambridge in 2005 for M.Phil. Meets Bilal and other co-conspirators.



METAMORPHOSIS Kafeel sported a goatee before leaving for Queen's (above). On return (right), his beard was the manifestation of his hardline views

